

Akamai Technologies Inc

Large Deal Momentum Continues

Summary

Following a steady stream of major CIS contract wins over the past few quarters, Akamai today announced an \$11.6B, 7-year Cloud Infrastructure Services contract with Anthropic ([link](#)) with an option to expand commitments by up to an additional \$9B. In addition to the contract, Anthropic will also receive warrants on Akamai shares equal to ~2% of shares outstanding, scaling up to ~5% if the full \$9B in additional contract value is exercised, which Akamai noted as a healthy way to deepen the partnership. Net, we see further upside to the low-teens FY27 growth guide following this deal, offset by a further margin/FCF hit as multi-year deals ramp. With \$4.6B of cash on the BS and a \$1B revolver, we also think Akamai might require further financing to cover an incremental \$5.5B in capex over the next 2 years. These large deal announcements have continued to support shares even against more in-line results and outlook, although at 5x CY27 EV/S and with limited FCF support we think shares already reflect this optimism.

Unpacking CIS business economics

In total, Akamai now has \$2.2B of ARR across \$14.4B in committed CIS spend, utilizing ~100MW of capacity. With this latest contract suggesting that 80%+ of TCV is coming from CPU compute, it's not surprising to see the \$/MW economics well above that of neoclouds. Against this \$2.2B of ARR, we see ~\$7B on capex (\$800-825M from the first Anthropic deal, \$5.5B from the second Anthropic deal, and ~\$500M across the other deals against ~\$300M of ARR), creating a ~mid-40s GM profile (assuming a 7-year useful life). While opex currently runs at ~30% of revs today, Akamai spoke to healthy leverage across these large deals given an already-established software stack and co-lo management team, such that we have more confidence in a mid-20s+ op. margin framework on these new deals once fully ramped (although pressuring OM and EPS medium term). On the financing side, the latest deal could provide Akamai with closer to \$1B in cash through warrant exercises, but with \$4.6B in cash today, we expect a need for Akamai to find further financing in the next 1-2 years.

Other relevant deal points

We'd note: 1) While details on exact use cases were not disclosed, Akamai noted this customer will be using Akamai infrastructure for multiple discrete use cases with potential for more in the future. 2) While the first contract has yet to ramp, Akamai suggested this second contract was won following positive experiences with testing on Akamai's platform. 3) Akamai clarified the \$11.6B is entirely CPU compute, leaving room for cross-sell opportunity.

Valuation:

We're raising our price target to \$148 from \$143, based on an unchanged 4.5x CY28E EV/S on our higher revenue estimate.

Equities

United States
Software

12-month rating **Neutral**

12m price target **US\$148.00**
Prior: US\$143.00

Price (24 Sep 2026) **US\$133.21**

RIC: AKAM.O BBG: AKAM US

Trading data and key metrics

52-wk range US\$161.14-71.97
Market cap. US\$17.0b
Shares o/s 154m (COM)
Free float 98%
Avg. daily volume ('000) 3,533
Avg. daily value (m) US\$406.1
Common s/h equity (12/26E) US\$5.21b
P/BV (12/26E) 3.1x
Net debt to EBITDA (12/26E) 3.6x

EPS (UBS, diluted) (USD)

	12/26E			
	From	To	% ch	Cons.
Q1	1.59	1.59	0	1.61
Q2	1.54	1.54	0	1.59
Q3E	1.64	1.64	0	1.68
Q4E	1.60	1.55	-3	1.81
12/26E	6.38	6.32	-1	6.70
12/27E	6.53	3.16	-52	7.21
12/28E	6.97	2.68	-61	8.20

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Highlights (US\$m)	12/23	12/24	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E	12/29E	12/30E
Revenues	3,812	3,991	4,208	4,510	5,278	6,447	7,228	7,584
EBIT (UBS)	1,136	1,168	1,255	1,119	631	547	660	740
Net earnings (UBS)	960	997	1,048	966	490	422	509	576
EPS (UBS, diluted) (US\$)	6.18	6.46	7.13	6.32	3.16	2.68	3.18	3.55
DPS (net) (US\$)	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
Net (debt) / cash	(2,674)	(1,949)	(2,919)	(6,339)	(8,152)	(8,502)	(7,674)	(6,643)
Profitability/valuation	12/23	12/24	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E	12/29E	12/30E
EBIT (UBS) margin %	29.8	29.3	29.8	24.8	12.0	8.5	9.1	9.8
ROIC (EBIT) %	17.7	16.6	17.0	11.5	5.0	3.9	4.7	5.5
EV/EBITDA (UBS core) x	10.4	10.7	8.1	12.4	13.9	12.6	11.1	10.1
P/E (UBS, diluted) x	15.3	15.8	11.4	17.5	34.9	41.1	34.7	31.1
Equity FCF (UBS) yield %	4.2	5.3	5.8	(11.3)	(16.0)	(1.5)	5.5	6.7
Dividend yield (net) %	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0

Source: Company accounts, LSEG Eikon, UBS estimates. Metrics marked as (UBS) have had analyst adjustments applied. Valuations: based on an average share price that year, (E): based on a share price of US\$ 133.21 on 24-Sep-2026 20:48:33 EDT

VARIANCE

Figure 1: Old vs. New Estimates

	3Q26			CY2026			CY2027			CY2028		
	New	Old	% Δ	New	Old	% Δ	New	Old	% Δ	New	Old	% Δ
Delivery Revenue	\$392.8	\$392.8	0.0%	\$1,574.6	\$1,574.6	0.0%	\$1,502.3	\$1,502.3	0.0%	\$1,423.7	\$1,423.7	0.0%
Security Revenue	\$622.0	\$622.0	0.0%	\$2,464.3	\$2,464.3	0.0%	\$2,676.6	\$2,676.6	0.0%	\$2,886.0	\$2,886.0	0.0%
CIS Revenue	\$109.3	\$109.3	0.0%	\$471.4	\$471.4	0.0%	\$1,099.3	\$948.8	15.9%	\$2,137.0	\$1,172.8	82.2%
Total Revenue	\$1,124.0	\$1,124.0	0.0%	\$4,510.3	\$4,510.3	0.0%	\$5,278.2	\$5,127.7	2.9%	\$6,446.7	\$5,482.5	17.6%
Operating Income	\$270.7	\$270.7	0.0%	\$1,118.1	\$1,128.6	-0.9%	\$630.9	\$1,238.5	-49.1%	\$546.7	\$1,337.9	-59.1%
Operating Margin	24.1%	24.1%	0 bps	24.8%	25.0%	-23 bps	12.0%	24.2%	-1220 bps	8.5%	24.4%	-1592 bps
Adjusted EBITDA	\$428.4	\$428.4	0.0%	\$1,742.8	\$1,730.7	0.7%	\$1,743.0	\$1,936.5	-10.0%	\$2,013.2	\$2,065.2	-2.5%
EBITDA Margin	38.1%	38.1%	0 bps	38.6%	38.4%	27 bps	33.0%	37.8%	-474 bps	31.2%	37.7%	-644 bps
EPS	\$1.64	\$1.64	\$0.00	\$6.32	\$6.37	-\$0.06	\$3.16	\$6.53	-\$3.37	\$2.68	\$6.97	-\$4.28
Operating Cash Flow	\$415.7	\$415.7	0.0%	\$1,552.8	\$1,543.2	0.6%	\$1,875.8	\$1,994.0	-5.9%	\$1,893.4	\$2,010.2	-5.8%
Free Cash Flow	(\$90.1)	(\$90.1)	0.0%	(\$1,917.9)	(\$229.3)	NM	(\$2,717.3)	\$550.7	-593.4%	(\$252.5)	\$750.8	-133.6%
Free Cash Flow Margin	-8.0%	-8.0%	0 bps	-42.5%	-5.1%	-3744 bps	-51.5%	10.7%	-6222 bps	-3.9%	13.7%	-1761 bps

Source: UBSe

Forecast returns

Forecast price appreciation	11.1%
Forecast dividend yield	0.0%
Forecast stock return	11.1%
Market return assumption	9.9%
Forecast excess return	1.2%

Company Description

Through its worldwide distributed edge, Akamai offers the world's largest Content Delivery Network service, along with a cybersecurity portfolio, including Web App Firewall, Bot management, and DDoS attack protection, along with a more recent compute portfolio service for both core cloud and edge workloads. Akamai was founded in 1998 and is headquartered in Cambridge, MA.

Valuation Method and Risk Statement

We value AKAM on an EV/S basis using comparable valuation of security and infrastructure vendors. This framework is supported by Rule of 40 analysis. Risks to our investment thesis: 1) Aggressive pricing pressure and muted volume growth in the CDN space; 2) Inability to effectively upsell Compute offerings to existing customers or attract core cloud infrastructure workloads away from the hyperscalers; 3) Execution risk around integrating and developing a rapidly expanding platform; 4) Material capex requirements to support a further Compute buildout, hampering the FCF profile; 5) A weaker topline outlook limiting margin expansion opportunity.

Quantitative Research Review

UBS Global Research publishes a quantitative assessment of its analysts' responses to certain questions about the likelihood of an occurrence of a number of short term factors in a product known as the 'Quantitative Research Review'. The views for this month can be found below. Views contained in this assessment on a particular stock reflect only the views on those short term factors which are a different timeframe to the 12-month timeframe reflected in any equity rating set out in this note. For previous responses please make reference to (i) previous UBS Global Research reports; and (ii) where no applicable research report was published that month, the Quantitative Research Review which can be found at <https://neo.ubs.com/quantitative>, or contact your UBS sales representative for access to the report or the Quantitative Research Team on ubs-quant-answers@ubs.com. A consolidated report which contains all responses is also available and again you should contact your UBS sales representative for details and pricing or the Quantitative Research Team on the email above.

Akamai Technologies Inc

Question	Response
1. Is the industry structure facing the firm likely to improve or deteriorate over the next six months? Rate on a scale of 1-5 (1 = getting worse, 3 = no change, 5 = getting better, N/A = no view)	4
2. Is the regulatory/government environment facing the firm likely to improve or deteriorate over the next six months? Rate on a scale of 1-5 (1 = getting tougher, 3 = no change, 5 = getting better, N/A = no view)	3
3. Over the last 3-6 months in broad terms have things been improving/no change/getting worse for this stock? Rate on a scale of 1-5 (1 = getting a lot worse, 3 = not much change, 5 = getting a lot better, N/A = no view)	4
4. Relative to the current CONSENSUS EPS forecast, is the next company EPS update likely to lead to: (1 = negative surprise vs consensus, 3 = in-line with consensus, 5 = positive surprise vs consensus expectations, N/A = no view)	3
5. What's driving the difference?	
6. Relative to YOUR current earnings forecast, is there relatively greater risk at the next earnings result of: (1 = downside skew risk to earnings, 3 = equal upside or downside risk to earnings, 5 = upside skew risk to earnings, N/A = no view)	3
7. What's driving the difference?	
8. Is there an upcoming catalyst for the company over the next three months?	
9. Is there an actual or approximate date for the catalyst?	
10. Is the catalyst date an actual or approximate date?	
11. What is the catalyst?	

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Neutral	FSR is between -6% and 6% of the MRA.	40%	21%
Sell	FSR is > 6% below the MRA.	6%	21%

Source: UBS. Rating allocations are as of 30 June 2026.

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UBS Securities LLC: Jack Fyda, Roger Boyd.

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Company Name	Reuters	12-month rating	Price	Price date
Akamai Technologies Inc ^{16,28}	AKAM.O	Neutral	US\$110.41	24 Sep 2026

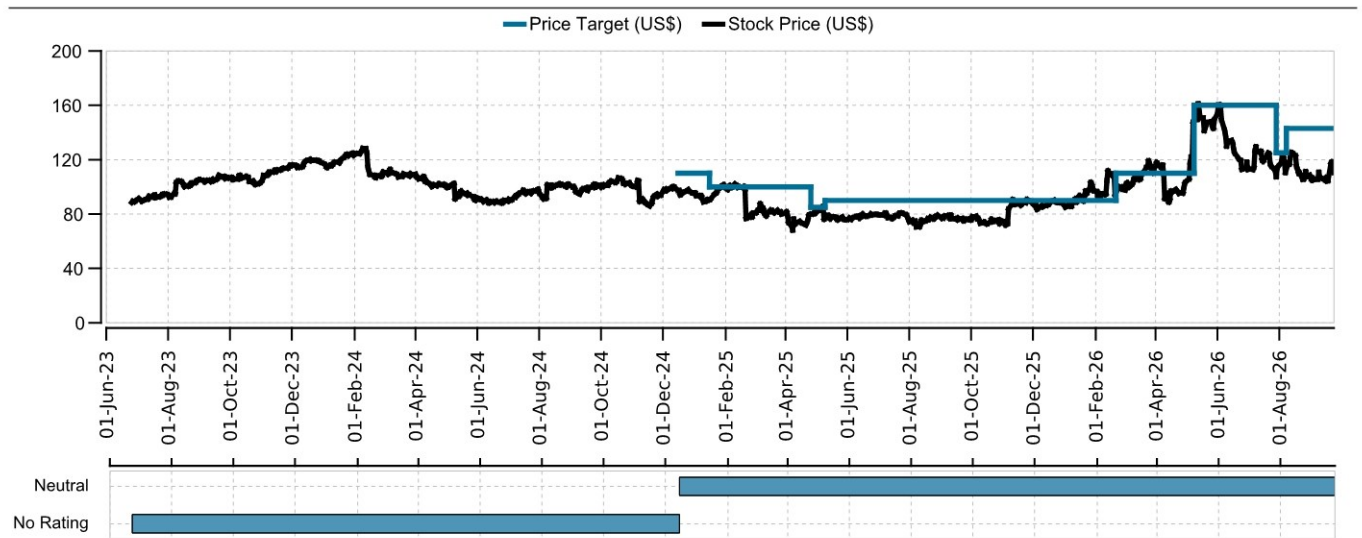
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Akamai Technologies Inc (US\$)



Date	Stock Price (US\$)	Price Target (US\$)	Rating
2023-06-23	88.63	-	No Rating
2024-12-15	99.24	110.00	Neutral
2025-01-15	90.52	100.00	Neutral
2025-04-25	79.79	85.00	Neutral
2025-05-09	76.25	90.00	Neutral
2026-02-20	94.17	110.00	Neutral
2026-05-08	147.71	160.00	Neutral
2026-07-28	111.79	125.00	Neutral
2026-08-07	110.54	143.00	Neutral

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon as of 24-Sep-2026. All prices as of local market close. Ratings as of date shown.

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